retreating in a coordinated manner. Meanwhile, Hitler's officers watched the entire affair while wondering why they had been ordered to wait.

On the 4th of June, Churchill refused to acknowledge the ‘miracle of Dunkirk’ as a triumph, in the House of Commons. Instead, he referred to it as ‘deliverance.’ He conveyed his famous speech ‘We shall fight on the beaches’ speech, and ended with the interminable words, 'We will never surrender.' Be that as it may, the French saw the retreat differently. They considered the Dunkirk departure a colossal betrayal, since Paris was surrounded by German forces at the time.

On the 10th of June, Italy proclaimed war on the Allies. After four days, Hitler's forces entered an evacuated Paris. More than 2 million citizens of Paris had fled south in fear of being massacred. Before long, the swastika was hung from the Arc de Triomphe as a symbol of Hitler’s victory.

On the 16th of June, Charles de Gaulle, a French General, ran away from France to live as an outcast in London. He was later captured and killed in absentia by the Vichy government. From London, de Gaulle stated: ‘France has lost a battle, however, France has not lost the war…the fire of French resistance must not and shall not die.’ His words turned into a call to war for the remaining French forces.

On June 16th, Prime Minister Paul Reynaud of France surrendered and was replaced by Marshal Philippe Pétain, a hero from the 1916 Battle of Verdun. Pétain's first decision was to look for a peace negotiation with the Germans and to request Reynaud's capture. On June 22nd, fifty miles north of Paris, the French formally surrendered to the Germans. Ironically, this took place in a similar area where the Germans were forced to surrender in 1918 at the end of the First World War. The railroad carriage and landmarks celebrating the 1918 victory were destroyed at Hitler’s request. The next day Hitler went to Paris for a tour throughout the city. On seeing Napoleon's tomb, he stated: ‘That was the greatest and finest moment of my life.’ Before withdrawing, he requested the decimation of two World War I landmarks including the dedication of Edith Cavell. Edith Cavell was a British attendant shot by the Germans in October 1915.